

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 9:30 pm CST on Tuesday 21 July 2026
for the period until midnight CST Friday 24 July 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A trough crosses South Australia on Tuesday evening, followed by a series of weak cold fronts that cross the south of the State during Wednesday. A ridge of high pressure will build over the west of the State from later Wednesday, with the high centre expected to cross South Australia on Friday and Saturday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southerly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots inshore in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloudy.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending southerly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to southwesterly during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: West to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning, then increasing to 3 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm offshore.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots south of Beachport. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Beachport. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm offshore.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 25 knots south of Beachport early in the morning and again in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Port MacDonnell. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning, then increasing to 3 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers, with possible small hail in the afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 20 to 25 knots increasing to 20 to 30 knots in the early afternoon then decreasing to 20 to 25 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Beachport. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers, with possible small hail in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 20 to 25 knots turning westerly 20 to 30 knots during the morning. Seas: 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Beachport. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly during the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots south of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to southwesterly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:40 am CST Wednesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.